

<http://www.ohiorivertrail.org>

March 7, 2011

Tri-State Trail Workshop, 3/29, 12:30-5pm, New Castle PA

Dear Trail Advocate:

As an identified key person, YOU are cordially invited by the National Park Service - *Rivers and Trails Program* to attend a **Tri State Trail Workshop** on Tuesday, March 29, 2011, from 12:30-5pm. This meeting will be held at the **Albert P. Gettings Government Center Annex Building**, located at **430 Court Street, New Castle, PA 16101** (It is the Church across from the Lawrence County Courthouse).

National Park Service
U.S. Department of the Interior



The National Park Service has approved the Ohio River Trail Council's application for technical assistance from the Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance (RTCA) Program. The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) was selected from the most competitive field of requests ever received by the National Park Service (NPS) and was one of only five new projects accepted in Pennsylvania.

The Ohio River Trail Council proposes the broad vision of a tri-state greenway system of interconnecting trails in Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The ORTC is working to develop a forty-one mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries in southwestern Pennsylvania, known as the Ohio River Trail (ORT). The ORT and the tri-state trail campaign originate at the U.S. Public Land Survey "Point of Beginning", a National Historic Landmark located near the three-way intersection of Ohio, Pennsylvania and the northern tip of West Virginia.

A workshop is planned to share **your projects** and ideas to facilitate trail connections in our tri-state region. The purpose of the meeting is to make connections across state lines, and to work with multiple groups to update existing and proposed trail maps, identify gaps, communicate your needs and concerns, and to continue **your efforts** as part of a larger system of linking trails.

For the initial meeting, we are focusing on trail corridors across three states and eighteen (18) counties bordering Pennsylvania, Ohio, and West Virginia. The counties include Pennsylvania: Beaver, Crawford, Erie, Greene, Lawrence, Mercer, Washington; Ohio: Ashtabula, Belmont, Columbiana, Jefferson, Mahoning, Monroe, Trumbull; West Virginia: Brooke, Hancock, Marshall, and Ohio.

All types of trails will be included in our mapping-- land and water trails, motorized and non-motorized trails. We ask that any available digital mapping in eastern Ohio, western Pennsylvania and the panhandle of West Virginia be sent directly to Allen Miller, GIS Planner at amiller@co.lawrence.pa.us or Lawrence County Planning Department, 430 Court Street, New Castle, PA 16101.

Please see our draft map for review and comment at <http://dl.dropbox.com/u/17673896/Regional%20Map.pdf>

We will have large maps available for mark-up at the workshop.

Workshop Agenda:

12:30-1:00 Sign-In

1:00-1:10 Welcome and Purpose

1:10-2:45 Introductions (Each county will be given five minutes to discuss what organizations are

represented and briefly report on trail efforts)

2:45-3:00 Break

3:00-4:00 Mapping Exercise (breaking out to specific areas)

4:00-4:45 Report-Out and Group Discussion

4:45-5:00 Next Steps

We ask that you bring a fact sheet about your organization, and any other materials, to distribute to the attendees. About 100 copies should be enough. Please feel free to pass this invitation on to other trail stakeholders in any of the 18 counties identified above.

Please RSVP by March 21, 2011 to:

- Doniele Andrus, Shared Greenways Planner, at dandrus@co.lawrence.pa.us, 724-658-3589, or
- Andrea Irland, Outdoor Recreation Planner, NPS-RTCA, at Andrea_Irland@nps.gov, 330-657-2378.

We all hope to see you on March 29!

Respectfully,

The Tri-State Trail Initiative Planning Committee

P.S.

The planning committee is composed of members of the National Parks Service, Rails-To-Trails Conservancy, Department of Conservation and Natural Resources and the [Ohio River Trail Council](#).

For further information regarding the National Park Service Rivers & Trails Program please visit <http://www.nps.gov/ncrc/programs/rtca/>

For further information regarding the Ohio River Trail Council please visit <http://www.ohiorivertrail.org>



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